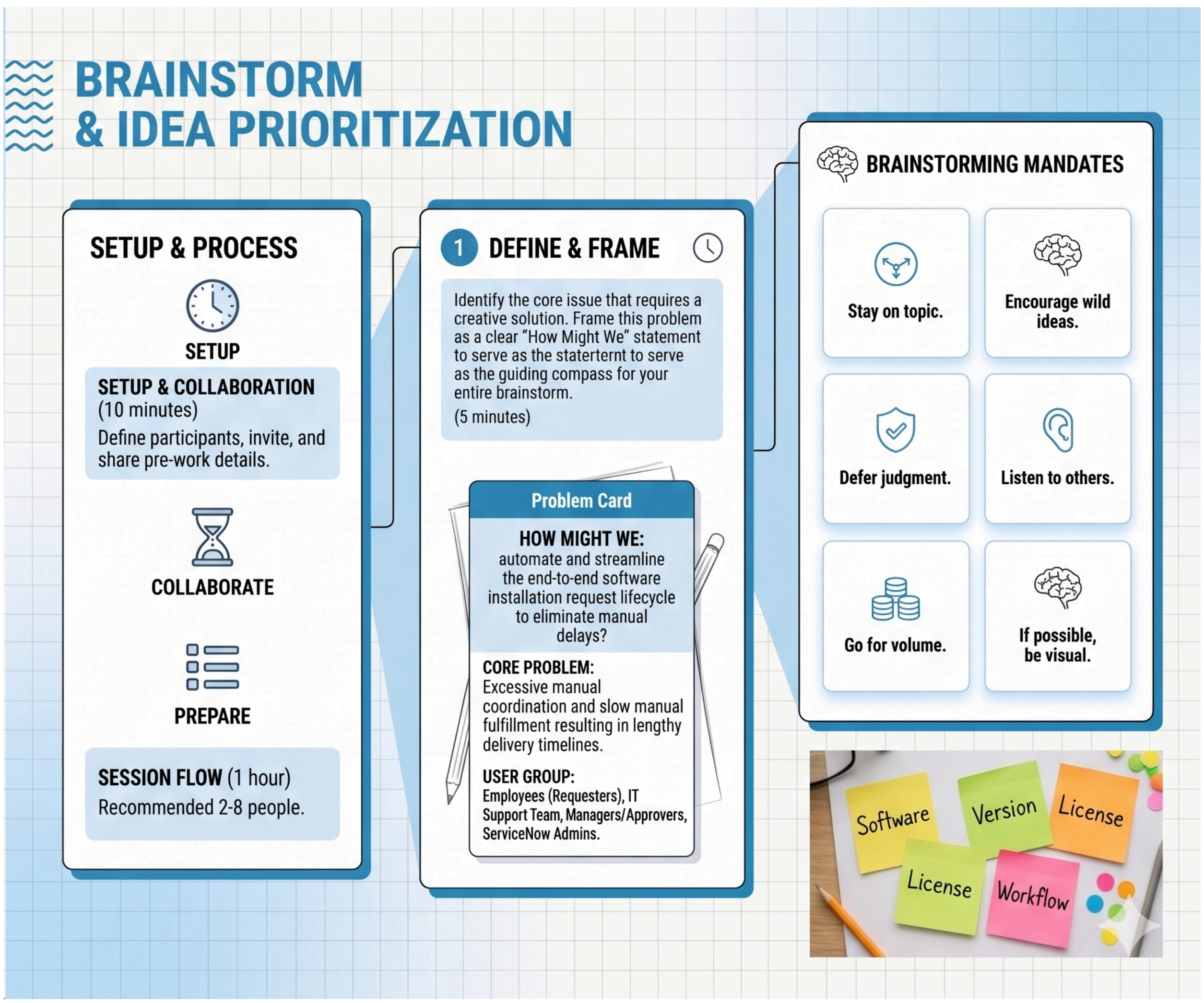
Ideation Phase
Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization

Date	**28-06-2026**
Project Name	**Software Installation Request Automation**
Team ID	
Maximum Marks	



Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

Before diving into ideas, it is essential to define the core focus and the right participants.

- **Problem Statement (How Might We):** How might we implement a fully automated software installation request process in ServiceNow to ensure proper manager approvals, enforce mandatory business justifications, and seamlessly generate fulfillment tasks for the IT team?
- **Team Gathering:** To tackle this, the session should include ServiceNow developers, IT Software Support staff, Software License Managers, and UI/UX testers to ensure the catalog variables are user-friendly and the backend workflows track data integrity perfectly.

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

Here is a list of brainstormed ideas clustered into related sub-groups based on the project milestones.

Cluster 1: Catalog Taxonomy & Form Experience

Design a dedicated catalog item for software requests, establishing mandatory fields for Software Name, Version, and Business Justification to prevent incomplete submissions.

Implement Client-side UI Policies to dynamically show or hide additional fields based on user selection (e.g., displaying specific requirements when "Licensed Software" is chosen).

Reduce manual effort by automatically populating the "Requested For" field with the logged-in user, and pulling their Department and Location dynamically from their profile.

Cluster 2: Automated Workflows & System Logic

Configure automated approval steps using Flow Designer to route requests to the Software Support Team dynamically.

Ensure Catalog Tasks (SCTASK) are automatically generated and assigned the moment a request is approved.

Implement a custom Server-side Business Rule to automatically trigger an Incident record if the ticket state is changed to "On Hold" due to a lack of available software licenses.

Cluster 3: Quality Assurance & Data Integrity

Conduct end-to-end testing to validate the complete lifecycle across all tables: Request (REQ), Requested Item (RITM), and Catalog Task (SCTASK).

Execute a Dictionary Override on the State field so the Service Portal explicitly displays "Approved" instead of a confusing numeric value, enhancing the end-user experience.

Package all configurations into a Local Update Set, mark it as Complete, and test the XML migration in a secondary instance to ensure no elements are missing upon deployment.

Step-3: Idea Prioritization

To determine which ideas are important and feasible, they are mapped onto an Importance vs. Feasibility grid.

Priority Level	**Idea / Task**	**Justification**
High Importance, High Feasibility (Do Now)	Build catalog item forms using variables and enforce mandatory fields (Software Name, Version).	Essential for capturing required data upfront; structurally straightforward to implement in ServiceNow.
High Importance, High Feasibility (Do Now)	Configure group approval steps and automated task generation using Flow Designer.	Critical for controlling software deployments and alerting IT; utilizes out-of-the-box Flow Designer actions.
High Importance, Low Feasibility (Plan Carefully)	Write an advanced Business Rule to trigger an Incident when the state changes to "On Hold".	Highly valuable for license management, but requires careful server-side scripting and state tracking to execute flawlessly.
High Importance, Low Feasibility (Plan Carefully)	Conduct end-to-end request simulations across REQ, RITM, and SCTASK tables.	Crucial for validating the entire ITIL lifecycle, but time-consuming to test every approval outcome and data binding.
Low Importance, High Feasibility (Quick Wins)	Auto-populate user details (Requested For, Department, Location) on form load.	Easy to execute via default values and immediately improves the user experience by saving them typing time.